LANDLORDLEDGER · RED FLAGS · FREE CHECKLIST

SEWER LINE CHECKLIST

3 red flags + 1 pro tip before you buy any house.

RED FLAG #3: SLOW DRAINS

- [ ] Several sinks, tubs or showers drain slowly at the same time
- [ ] Run water in each fixture for a minute during your showing

RED FLAG #2: GURGLING

- [ ] Toilets gurgle or bubble when the washer or shower runs
- [ ] Sewage smell in the basement or near a floor drain

RED FLAG #1: TREES + GREEN PATCH

- [ ] Big, old trees near the path of the sewer line
- [ ] One strip or patch of lawn greener or softer than the rest

ASK THE SELLER

- [ ] Pipe material (clay, cast iron, PVC, fiber) _____
- [ ] Any past backups, root cutting, or line repairs? Receipts?

PRO TIP

- [ ] Order a sewer scope (camera inspection) before your inspection deadline
- [ ] Get the video + a written quote; ask the seller for a fix or credit
- [ ] Check whether your insurance covers service lines (often not standard)
- [ ] **BONUS: the old pipe roots love to break: revealed in the next Red Flags episode**

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